NATIONAL CHILD DAY / WORLD CHILDREN'S DAY

Every child. Every right.

NOVEMBER 20, 2026





Fair treatment

Rights belong to every child.

Article 2



A voice that matters

Adults listen and take our views seriously.

Article 12



Learning and growing

Education helps our abilities flourish.

Articles 28-29



Play, rest and create

Time for play, rest, culture and art.

Article 31



Health and safety

Care, clean water and protection from harm.

Articles 19 and 24



Language and culture

Our languages and cultures are respected.

Article 30

What helps every child belong and be heard?

Rights are not rewards. Adults help make them real.

Selected UN Convention on the Rights of the Child articles, paraphrased. Original classroom theme.

Start with rights. Listen with care.

Walnut Road Elementary | Primary K-3, intermediate 4-7 and Leadership / Spirit Crew

Use one activity or connect the pathways. This is a proposed classroom resource, not an approved school campaign or a commitment to an assembly, collection or school-wide project.

A simple opening

Children have rights because they are children. Rights are not prizes for good behaviour. Governments and adults have responsibilities to uphold them. We can respect one another while asking adults to remove barriers. Today we will explore what helps every child belong and be heard.

K-3 | ABOUT 20-25 MINUTES

Notice the poster. Name a right together. Use page 3 to draw, build, write or tell an idea for a welcoming school. Sharing is optional.

4-7 | ABOUT 30-40 MINUTES

Read a short scenario on page 4. Connect a right to evidence, separate facts from guesses, and suggest a fairer decision process.

Make participation safe and accessible

- Offer drawing, writing, speaking, home languages, assistive communication, an adult scribe or a quiet pass. No child has to share personal experiences.
- Use fictional situations. Do not ask a child to represent a culture, race, disability or family. Discuss barriers and adult actions, not who deserves rights.
- No pupil names, photos or private stories on collected work. An optional anonymous idea is enough. Explain who will see it before inviting it.
- If a child shares a safety concern, respond privately and follow school safeguarding procedures. Do not promise secrecy or use a public display.

Learning connections

BC Core Competencies: Social Awareness and Responsibility (inclusion and community); Communicating (listening and expressing ideas); Critical and Reflective Thinking (evidence, criteria and revising a proposal). These are suggested connections, not a grade-specific curriculum audit.

Notice learning: Can students identify a right, listen without ranking voices, and connect an idea to evidence? Assess the thinking, not personal disclosure or participation in a campaign.

A school where everyone belongs

Draw, write, build or tell an idea. You can share with a trusted adult, or choose to pass.

LEARN **PLAY AND REST** **BE HEARD**

Every child has these rights. Adults help children enjoy them. Different children may need different supports.

Imagine a welcoming classroom, playground or garden.

Show something that helps children learn, play or share ideas.

My picture or model could show...

My idea helps children to...

An adult could help by...

Try together: Play is a right. A favourite game is a preference. There can be many fair ways to make play possible. What could adults offer so more children can join?

A right. A clue. A fairer choice.

Use evidence from this fictional situation, not a classmate's private experience.

The outdoor learning plan

A school wants to improve its outdoor learning area. Adults invite ideas through one lunchtime meeting. Students must speak to the whole group. The plan is chosen before children who missed the meeting can respond.

Rights lens | selected UNCRC articles, paraphrased

2: Rights apply without discrimination. **12:** Children can express views about matters affecting them, and adults take those views seriously. **23:** Children with disabilities must be able to participate in community life.

1. Evidence: What does the scenario actually tell us?

2. A question, not a guess: What do we still need to find out?

3. Claim + right: Which article helps explain a barrier to being heard?

4. Proposal: What should adults change? Give two ways to contribute.

5. Check: What evidence would show that participation improved?

Think further: Fairness is not always the same support for everyone. Whose ideas might still be missing? No student has to speak for a whole group. Adults explain the final decision and how children's views influenced it.

Listen first. Choose one change.

A small listening project, if staff choose to use it. No money, sign-ups or public personal stories needed.

Before inviting ideas

Ask an adult sponsor to agree to a manageable scope, private collection method, who reads responses and when students will hear back. If this is not ready, practise with fictional ideas instead.

1 Invite, without pressure

Ask: **What helps every child belong and be heard?** Invite an optional anonymous drawing or note, or a conversation with an adult. Offer accessible ways and enough time. A quiet pass is welcome.

OPTIONAL IDEA SLIP | No name needed

One thing that could help more children belong is...

2 Notice patterns, not people

With the adult, group ideas without names or identifying details. Notice quieter or less common suggestions as well as popular ones. A majority vote cannot take away another child's rights.

3 Choose one achievable proposal

Check it against three criteria: removes a barrier; includes more ways to participate; has adult support and a realistic next step. Ask who may still be left out before choosing.

Our proposed change and the right it supports:

A barrier this could remove, and a question we still need to ask:

Student leaders listen and suggest. Adults remain responsible for safety, fairness, decisions and follow-through.

Show children what happened next.

Complete only if the listening activity is adopted. Share an accessible summary, not individual responses.

We heard these ideas / concerns (themes only):

Our decision and why: What can happen, what cannot, and why?

How children's views shaped the decision:

Adult role responsible:

First step:

Review date:

How and when children will hear back, including those who did not participate:

At the review: Ask whether the change reduced the barrier. Invite optional feedback in more than one way. Keep, adapt or revisit it, then explain what happens next. Store and dispose of responses under school policy.

Sources and scope

Original learning activities and classroom theme; not an official 2026 campaign theme or a full statement of the Convention. Rights wording is simplified. Use the source text for fuller meaning.

Government of Canada: National Child Day

UNICEF: World Children's Day 2026 (November 20)

UNICEF: Convention on the Rights of the Child, children's version

BC curriculum: Social Awareness and Responsibility

BC curriculum: Communicating

BC curriculum: Critical and Reflective Thinking